The course map

Every lesson answers one question you will be asked at work. Start at the bottom rung; each one builds on the rung below.

THE PROMISE: THREE JOBS

MAKE

Pick the model that fits the question, feed it honest inputs, and get a ranking you believe.

DEFEND

Bring your inputs, not just your score, so a leader challenges an assumption instead of overruling a number.

PROVE

Decide before you ship how you will know it worked, then measure or test it honestly.

Then repeat next quarter.

THE QUESTION LADDER

AT THE TOP **All of it, under pressure**	**CAPSTONE** Tallyrow's next quarter: a competitor moves, the CEO escalates, a deadline will not move	YOU LEAVE WITH **Your decision pack and a one-page memo**
YOU GET ASKED **How do we keep doing this every quarter?**	**AGILE CADENCE** Models inside sprints and quarterly planning, and the metrics review rhythm	YOU LEAVE WITH **The review cadence sheet**
YOU GET ASKED **Did it actually work?**	**EXPERIMENTS** Test design, sample size, reading results honestly, then ship, kill or iterate	YOU LEAVE WITH **The experiment brief**
YOU GET ASKED **How will we know if it worked?**	**MEASURING SUCCESS** Inputs vs outputs, the North Star, metric trees, HEART and AARRR, the NPS question, funnels and cohorts, diagnosing a drop, guardrails	YOU LEAVE WITH **The metric tree and metrics spec**
YOU GET ASKED **Is this idea worth building at all?**	**EVALUATING IDEAS** Kano, Lean Startup and the MVP, assumption mapping, product-market fit, opportunity solution trees	YOU LEAVE WITH **The evaluated idea brief**
YOU GET ASKED **What do we build first?**	**PRIORITISATION** Value vs effort, ICE, weighted scoring, RICE, MoSCoW, Cost of Delay and WSJF, then handling the leadership escalation	YOU LEAVE WITH **The Tallyrow prioritisation workbook**
YOU GET ASKED **Where does this decision sit in the life of the product?**	**LIFECYCLE** Development patterns, the four product risks, the product lifecycle, and which model fits which moment	YOU LEAVE WITH **The decision map**

THE RUNNING EXAMPLE

FICTIONAL

Tallyrow

Invoicing and payments for freelancers and small businesses, on web and mobile. The job customers hire it for: **getting paid on time**. You are the product manager who has just taken over quarterly planning.

~40,000
paying businesses

61%
invoices paid on time

8 asks
three squads, room for about three

Set up once, build alongside

The hands-on lessons use the same kinds of tools product teams use at work. Every tool below has a no-cost option.

PERISHABLE Tool names, plans and limits change. If your screen differs, the steps still apply.

THE TOOLS

SPREADSHEETS AND SURVEYS

Google Sheets and Google Forms

The scoring workbooks (RICE, MoSCoW, Cost of Delay, WSJF), the Kano survey and its analysis. **Excel** also works for the workbooks.

SET UP
A free Google account.

VISUAL CANVAS

Miro or FigJam

Assumption maps, opportunity solution trees and metric trees.

Free plans cap you at 3 boards (Miro) or 3 FigJam files. Use one board with a section per exercise.

SET UP
Sign up for a free plan with your work or personal email.

PRODUCT ANALYTICS AND EXPERIMENTS

PostHog

Funnels, cohorts, a live metric-tree branch, and A/B test results with an automatic sample-ratio check.

Free plan: 1 project, 1M analytics events and 1M feature-flag requests a month; experiments count against flag requests.

SET UP
Create a free cloud account (no credit card) and one project. The demo-data loader comes with the lesson that needs it.

SAMPLE-SIZE CALCULATOR

Evan Miller's A/B testing tools

Sizing an experiment before launch, independent of any one vendor.

SET UP
Nothing to install and no account. Bookmark evanmiller.org/ab-testing

GOOD HABITS FOR THE HANDS-ON LESSONS

- [ ] **Tallyrow copy first, then yours.** Every template comes filled in for Tallyrow, with a blank copy for your own product.
- [ ] **Keep real data out of unapproved tools.** Never paste customer data or confidential numbers into a tool your employer has not cleared.
- [ ] **Look for the same setting under a new name.** Interfaces move; the concept behind each step does not.
- [ ] **Build alongside.** Pause the recording and do each step yourself before moving on.

SETUP CHECKLIST

☐ Google account ☐ Miro or FigJam ☐ PostHog project ☐ Sample-size calculator bookmarked